CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

LOGISTICS COORDINATOR IN THE AI ERA

E-commerce made supply chains twitchier, not simpler — BLS projects +18% growth for the people who untangle them. AI writes the plan; humans handle everything the plan didn't survive.

★ TL;DR — Median ~$82K (BLS Logisticians, $82,320, May 2025), growth +18%, ~26,600 openings a year. The honest gate is a bachelor's degree — BLS's typical entry — not a certificate: APICS certifications are voluntary extras. The catch: the routine planning half (forecast checks, PO chasing, vendor emails) is exactly what agentic software is absorbing, so the degree plus exception-handling judgment is the package. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

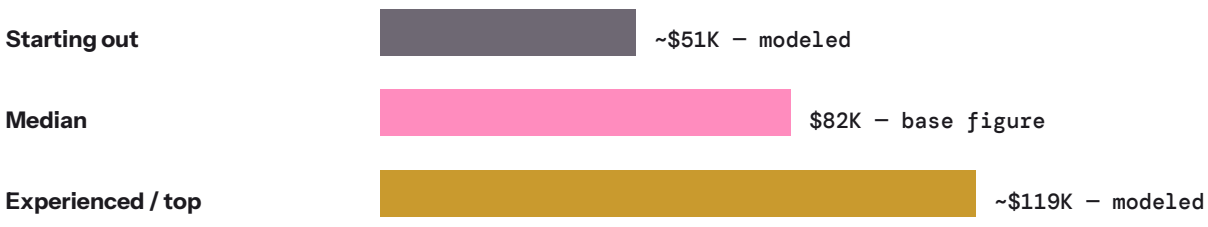
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$82K · TRAINING 2-4 years · AI RISK MEDIUM

- BLS's growth driver is complexity: as e-commerce makes logistics 'more dynamic and complex', logisticians stay in demand — +44,900 jobs by 2035.
- The coordinator title is the support rung under a logistician; BLS notes some enter from logistical-support roles, with employers sometimes substituting experience for the degree.
- AI takes the routine first: Gartner expects supply-chain software with agentic AI to grow from <$2B (2025) to $53B by 2030 — forecast and follow-up work is the target.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Logistics Coordinator is a ~$82K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars

are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A LOGISTICS COORDINATOR ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Analyze and coordinate the supply chain: purchasing, warehousing, distribution
- ✓ Track shipments and inventory; fix exceptions when reality disagrees with the plan
- ✓ Follow up purchase orders and vendor deliveries
- ✓ Brief customers and internal teams on status, delays and options

Think: air-traffic control for freight — the software files the flight plans; you handle the storms, strikes and missed connections.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Microsoft's Dynamics 365 Copilot Supplier Communications Agent already automates follow-up emails to vendors and matches them to purchase orders; demand-planning copilots answer forecast questions; McKinsey figures (via industry coverage) put AI forecasting error cuts at 20–50% and administration cost cuts at 25–40%.	Exceptions: the port closure, the supplier who goes quiet, the shipment that matters more than the contract says. Liaison and problem-solving under time pressure — core BLS duties — are the growing half of the job.

⚠ **Ignore 'coordinator in 12 weeks, no degree' ads for this occupation: BLS's typical entry is a bachelor's, and the $82,320 median (federal government: $103,790) belongs to degree-holding logisticians. The support-seat route exists, but it's the slower road to the same desk.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ The fastest growth in this batch of business careers: +18% ✓ Every industry moves freight — options everywhere ✓ Desk-based, partly remote, with a clear ladder into supply-chain leadership	✗ Peak seasons and disruptions mean surge weeks ✗ You deliver the bad news when the plan dies ✗ Routine planning tasks shrink yearly — judgment is the job, or nothing is

Good fit? Detail-obsessed, unflappable, and energized by problems that don't repeat.
Bad fit? You want a clerical desk that stays the same; this one's routine half is being automated on purpose.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — DEGREE ROUTE (THE BLS DOOR)	DOOR B — SUPPORT SEAT UP
Bachelor's in supply chain, business or a related field → logistician postings directly. This is the route the $82,320 median describes, and federal roles ($103,790 median) sit behind it. Internships in warehousing or procurement during the degree are the standard accelerant.	BLS itself names the side door: some logisticians enter from logistical-support roles — material recording, shipping/receiving, dispatch — with experience sometimes substituting for the degree. Slower and employer-dependent, but real. Add an APICS credential (CSCP/CLTD) on this route as a differentiator — voluntary, never a licence.

Smart move: Learn exception math: anyone can read a dashboard; the hireable skill is quantifying a disruption and pricing the fix before the meeting starts.
Where you land after: Senior logistician → supply chain / operations manager → broader logistics leadership, with federal and manufacturing seats at the top of the pay range.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
MAP THE	TAKE THE	BANK OPERATIONS	AUTOMATE THE	ADD APICS	RUN EXCEPTIONS,

STEP 1 — Map the real occupation

FREE · TODAY

- Read BLS's Logisticians page: $82,320, +18%, bachelor's typical entry
- Note the industry split — federal $103,790 vs transportation & warehousing $63,530

STEP 2 — Take the degree route seriously

YEARS 1-4

- Bachelor's in supply chain, business or a related field is the standard track
- If a degree is impossible this decade, plan Door B knowingly — support seat, slower clock

STEP 3 — Bank operations exposure

PAID · DURING

- Warehouse, procurement or dispatch roles and internships while studying
- Any TMS/ERP time goes on the résumé — employers screen for systems

STEP 4 — Automate the routine yourself

MONTHS

- Learn the planning tools and their AI features; be the user, not the victim
- Spreadsheet and basic data skills are assumed — exceed them

STEP 5 — Add APICS — as a differentiator

EXAM FEES · OPTIONAL

- CSCP/CLTD are voluntary certifications (ASCM) — they polish a profile; they don't unlock a licence
- Take them after experience gives the theory something to stick to

STEP 6 — Run exceptions, get promoted

WORKING · YEAR 1+

- Own a lane or a supplier set; measure your disruption outcomes
- The promotion metric is problems prevented, not emails answered

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: read the BLS Logisticians page and pick your door — degree or support seat.

□ Days 1–30: degree plan or support-role applications underway; vocabulary and systems study started.

□ Days 31–60: operations exposure secured (job, internship or project); TMS/ERP practice begun.

□ Days 61–90: first exception story documented with numbers — your interview asset.

□ Day 90: you're on the +18% occupation's actual entry path, not the certificate shortcut it never promised.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **PLANS ARE SOFTWARE. EXCEPTIONS ARE YOURS.** ★